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Redefining BHARAT

PRIME MINISTER NARENDRA MODI HAS BEEN AN UNSTOPPABLE FORCE IN 2023, LEAVING HIS MARK ON BOTH THE NATIONAL AND INTERNATIONAL STAGE. ANALYSING THE MANY AVATARS MODI DONNED TO MAKE IT POSSIBLE

By **RAJ CHENGAPPA**

NARENDRA MODI, AS PRIME MINISTER, FITS NO STEREOTYPE and remains an enigma despite this being his 10th year in office. Like the gods of Hindu mythology, he is a man of many avatars, some of which came to the fore in 2023 and enabled him to become, well, the man of the moment, for the moment and by the moment. He can look back at 2023 as his annus mirabilis even though for most world leaders the year was annus horribilis. Especially with two major wars—Ukraine and Gaza—widening the divide between nations already reeling under the combined onslaught of a global economic slowdown and Covid's long shadow. Modi's aura of unpredictability and his bold decisions proved advantageous in these crisis-ridden times. Amid the global strife and rubble, he emerged with a rare double credit for his masterful handling of issues on the domestic front and the international stage, making him the cynosure of the globe. In 2023, it was Cometh the Hour, Cometh Modi.

THE REFORMER

Let's start with Modi the Reformer. In his first term, Modi brought in major economic reform by pushing for a one nation, one tax regime that saw the introduction of the national Goods and Services Tax (GST). In his second term, the prime minister focused on path-breaking social and political reforms. This September, in a historic decision to politically empower Indian women, the prime minister got Parliament to pass the Women's Reservation Act, 2023. The Act ordained that 33 per